末日种子库的第一次取种

The Day the Doomsday Vault Opened



全球种子保险箱第一次为谁打开?

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英文原文

On Spitsbergen, in Norway's Svalbard archipelago, a corridor has been drilled deep into a frosted hillside. At its end, cartons of precious seed sit silently in a sub-zero repository, insulated by permanently frozen ground.

The Svalbard Global Seed Vault opened near Longyearbyen in February 2008 to insure crops such as beans, rice, and wheat against the horrors people dread, from atomic war to disease. It has ample room for about four and a half million samples. Essentially the planet's ultimate backup, it is run like a bank's safe-deposit box. Depositors keep ownership, and only they can take their seeds out.

The first retrieval came not after an asteroid strike but amid strife on the ground. ICARDA, a research centre whose gene bank stood near Aleppo, had moved its headquarters to Beirut during Syria's civil war. In September 2015 it asked for about 116,000 samples, 130 of the 325 boxes it had sent to the Arctic before the hostilities. They included robust strains of wheat and barley tolerant of drought and heat.

In Lebanon and Morocco, ICARDA sowed the seeds, and vigorous plants sprouted to regenerate its collection. Once multiplication had gone far enough, a homecoming began in 2017, consignment by consignment, restocking the Arctic stronghold.

That same year brought a scare. After record-breaking warmth, meltwater ran into the roughly 100-metre entrance tunnel and solidified. The intrusion stopped short of the seeds, which stayed safely at minus 18 degrees Celsius. Norway waterproofed the tunnel and dug drainage ditches.

A haven built against the apocalypse had a weakness at its own entrance, and warmer weather found it.

中文译文

在挪威斯瓦尔巴群岛的斯匹次卑尔根岛，一条通道深深钻入结霜的山坡。通道尽头，一箱箱珍贵种子静静存放在零度以下的储藏库里，永久冻土为它们提供隔热保护。

斯瓦尔巴全球种子库于2008年2月在朗伊尔城附近启用，为豆类、水稻、小麦等作物提供保障，以防人们畏惧的种种灾难，从核战争到病害。库内空间充足，可容纳约450万份样本。它实质上是地球最后一道种子备份，运作方式类似银行保险箱：存放者保留种子的所有权，也只有他们有权取回。

这座种子库的首次取种，并非发生在小行星撞击之后，而是在地面战乱之中。研究中心ICARDA的基因库原设在阿勒颇附近，叙利亚内战期间，其总部迁往贝鲁特。2015年9月，该中心申请取回约11.6万份样本，即战事发生前由它送往北极的325箱中的130箱。其中包括耐旱、耐热的健壮小麦和大麦品系。

ICARDA在黎巴嫩和摩洛哥播下这些种子，茁壮的植株萌发生长，重建了该中心自己的种子样本库。繁育数量足够多后，一场回归之旅于2017年开始：种子一批接一批送回，重新补充这座北极堡垒。

同年，种子库也经历了一场虚惊。创纪录的暖天气过后，融水流入约100米长的入口隧道，并凝结成冰。但水和冰没有抵达种子存放处，种子始终安全保存在零下18摄氏度。挪威随后给隧道加做防水，并挖出排水沟。

这座为抵御末日灾难而建的庇护所，弱点却在自己的入口，变暖的天气把它暴露了出来。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

corridor n.
通道；走廊
a corridor has been drilled

repository n.
储藏库
a sub-zero repository

insulate v.
隔热保护
insulated by permanently frozen ground

seed vault 名词短语
种子储藏库
The Svalbard Global Seed Vault

insure v.
为……提供保障
insure crops such as beans

ample adj.
充足的
ample room

backup n.
备份；后备
the planet's ultimate backup

ownership n.
所有权
Depositors keep ownership

retrieval n.
取回
The first retrieval

strife n.
冲突；战乱
amid strife on the ground

gene bank 名词短语
基因库；种质资源库
a research centre whose gene bank

headquarters n.
总部
moved its headquarters to Beirut

robust adj.
健壮的；适应力强的
robust strains of wheat and barley

strain n.
作物品系
robust strains of wheat and barley

tolerant of 形容词短语
能耐受……的
tolerant of drought and heat

sow v.
播种
ICARDA sowed the seeds

regenerate v.
重新繁育；恢复
to regenerate its collection

consignment n.
一批运送的货物
consignment by consignment

restock v.
重新补充库存
restocking the Arctic stronghold

intrusion n.
侵入
The intrusion stopped short

stop short of 动词短语
在到达……前停住
stopped short of the seeds

drainage n.
排水
dug drainage ditches

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共39项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

archipelago n.
群岛

drill v.
钻凿

frosted adj.
覆着霜的

hillside n.
山坡

carton n.
纸箱

precious adj.
珍贵的

silently adv.
静静地

sub-zero adj.
零度以下的

permanently adv.
永久地

bean n.
豆类

against prep.
防范；抵御

horror n.
可怕的灾难

dread v.
畏惧

atomic adj.
原子能的；核的

essentially adv.
实质上；基本上

ultimate adj.
最终的；最后一道的

safe-deposit box 名词短语
银行保险箱

depositor n.
存放者

asteroid n.
小行星

civil war 名词短语
内战

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共39项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

ask for 动词短语
申请取回；请求

Arctic 专有名词
北极地区

hostilities 复数名词
战事；敌对行动

barley n.
大麦

vigorous adj.
茁壮的；旺盛的

sprout v.
发芽

multiplication n.
繁殖；扩繁

homecoming n.
回归

stronghold n.
堡垒；坚固据点

scare n.
虚惊；惊慌

record-breaking adj.
破纪录的

tunnel n.
隧道

solidify v.
凝固

safely adv.
安全地

waterproof v.
做防水处理

ditch n.
沟渠

haven n.
庇护所；安全之地

apocalypse n.
末日灾难

weakness n.
弱点

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Depositors keep _____, and only they can take their seeds out.

02 The first _____ came not after an asteroid strike but amid strife on the ground.

03 robust strains of wheat and barley _____ drought and heat.

04 The _____ stopped short of the seeds, which stayed safely at minus 18 degrees Celsius.

文章主线

- 备份 2008年启用的斯瓦尔巴种子库，为防战争、病害保存农作物种子备份；种子归存放者，只有他们能取回。
- 取种 叙利亚内战中，农业研究中心ICARDA迁移总部；2015年取回自存的部分备份约11.6万份，这是种子库首次出库。
- 重建 该中心在黎巴嫩、摩洛哥繁育种子，恢复自己的种子样本库，并从2017年起分批将种子存回北极。
- 虚惊 同年，高温后的融水进入入口隧道并结冰，未触及种子；种子仍安全保存在零下18摄氏度。
- 加固 挪威给隧道加做防水并开挖排水沟，修补这座全球种子保险箱因天气变暖而暴露的入口弱点。

参考答案　1 ownership 2 retrieval 3 tolerant of 4 intrusion